



APPS



ChatGPT's mobile app has generated \$2B to date, earns \$2.91 per install

ChatGPT's mobile app is raking in the revenue.

Since launching in [May 2023](#), ChatGPT's app for iOS and Android devices has reached \$2 billion in global consumer spending, according to a new analysis by app intelligence provider [Appfigures](#). That figure is approximately 30x the combined lifetime spending of ChatGPT's rivals on mobile, including Claude, Copilot, and Grok, the analysis indicates.

So far this year, ChatGPT's mobile app has made \$1.35 billion, up 673% year-over-year from the \$174 million it made during the same period (January-July) in 2024, per the data. On average, the app is generating close to \$193 million per month, up from \$25 million last year.

That's significantly higher — or about 53x higher — than ChatGPT's next nearest competitor, Grok, which made approximately \$25.6 million this year to date. Grok's average monthly consumer spending is estimated at \$3.6 million, or 1.9% of ChatGPT's.

IMAGE CREDITS:

1.9% OF CHATGPT'S: SHUTTERSTOCK / GETTY IMAGES

This data suggests that other consumer chatbots still have a way to go to catch up with ChatGPT's dominance on mobile devices, even if the numbers don't provide a complete picture of the AI companies' overall revenue. Consumers, teams, and businesses can also subscribe to AI plans on the web, and the companies generate revenue in other ways, too, like [via their APIs](#).

Rather, this new data offers a window into the apps' traction with consumers, who discover and pay for these AI assistants via the mobile app stores.

It's also worth noting that when xAI's Grok launched in November 2023 (after ChatGPT), Grok didn't initially have stand-alone iOS or Android apps. Instead, users interacted with the AI chatbot through the X platform. Grok only became available on mobile devices through its own iOS app as of early [January 2025](#) and has been on [Google Play](#) since March 4.

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Revenue Per Download for Top AI General Assistant Apps

Estimated Consumer Spending • Worldwide • iOS and Google Play

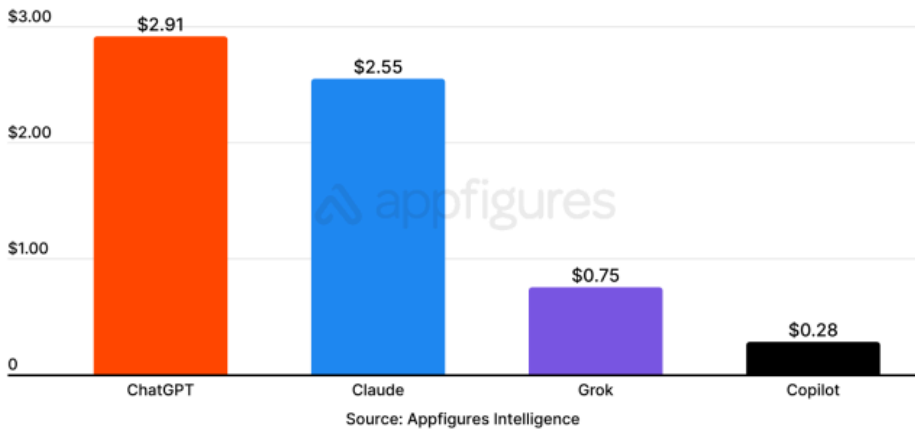


IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

Still, ChatGPT's lifetime global spending per download is \$2.91, compared to Claude's \$2.55, Grok's \$0.75, and Copilot's \$0.28, Appfigures found.

In the U.S., ChatGPT's spending per download to date is even higher, at \$10, leading the market to account for 38% of the app's revenue to date. Germany is the second-largest market, accounting for 5.3% of ChatGPT's lifetime total spending.

ChatGPT's lead can also be seen in terms of downloads. To date, the app has been installed an estimated 690 million times globally, compared with Grok's 39.5 million. (That puts [X owner Elon Musk's recent complaints](#) about the App Store's alleged favoritism of ChatGPT in its Top Charts into better context.)

Average monthly downloads of ChatGPT globally are now at approximately 45 million, up 180% from about 16 million in January through July of 2024.

In 2025 so far, ChatGPT's app has been downloaded 318 million times, or 2.8x more than the 113 million it saw during the same period last year. By the number of installs, however, India is the top market, accounting for 13.7% of lifetime downloads, compared with second place, the U.S., which accounted for 10.3% of all downloads.

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Sarah Perez

Consumer News Editor | [X](#) [T](#) [@](#) [in](#)

Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having previously spent over three years at...

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X's declining Android app installs are hurting subscription revenue

Sarah Perez — 1:49 PM PDT · August 18, 2025

Elon Musk's X is struggling on Android devices in terms of new installs, even while App Store downloads grow, according to new data from app intelligence provider Appfigures. In July 2025, X downloads on Google Play saw a significant decline, as new installs dropped by 44% year-over-year worldwide, even as iOS downloads grew by 15%.

This steep drop in installs is pulling down X's overall average, leading to a 26% decrease in total mobile downloads year-

Advertisement

over-year as of July. That’s still slightly better than the month prior, when total downloads had fallen by 35%, thanks to another sharp drop in Android downloads, which were then down by nearly half (49%) year-over-year.

New X Downloads on Mobile by Month

Estimated Downloads • Worldwide • App Store and Google Play



IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

The firm didn’t speculate on what’s causing the decline on Android devices beyond suggesting that the X app on Android is known to be a sore spot for the company. Recently hired [X head of product Nikita Bier](#), known for growth hacking teen social apps like [Gas](#) and [TBH](#) (then [selling them](#)), has hinted that X is looking to address issues on Android, where its app is [notoriously buggy](#) and [often crashes](#).

In a post on the platform, Bier [announced](#) that X was hiring for its “Android Dream Team” to work on rebuilding the X Android app. He also recently posted that X’s iOS app [had just seen a record week in terms of installs](#), perhaps hoping to draw attention away from the large Android slump.



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New X Downloads on Mobile by Month with Year-Over-Year Growth

Estimated Downloads • Worldwide • App Store and Google Play

Month	App Store	YoY	Google Play	YoY	Unified	YoY
Jan-24	2,963,000	-	6,303,000	-	9,266,000	-
Feb-24	3,623,000	-	6,352,000	-	9,975,000	-
Mar-24	3,363,000	-	6,689,000	-	10,052,000	-
Apr-24	2,971,000	-	7,536,000	-	10,507,000	-
May-24	2,993,000	-	7,676,000	-	10,669,000	-
Jun-24	3,514,000	-	8,787,000	-	12,301,000	-
Jul-24	3,429,000	-	7,742,000	-	11,171,000	-
Aug-24	3,338,000	-	7,953,000	-	11,291,000	-
Sep-24	2,679,000	-	6,347,000	-	9,026,000	-
Oct-24	2,876,000	-	5,895,000	-	8,771,000	-
Nov-24	2,629,000	-	5,735,000	-	8,364,000	-
Dec-24	2,691,000	-	5,861,000	-	8,552,000	-
Jan-25	3,312,000	12%	6,019,000	-5%	9,331,000	1%
Feb-25	3,475,000	-4%	5,535,000	-13%	9,010,000	-10%
Mar-25	3,359,000	0%	6,814,000	2%	10,173,000	1%
Apr-25	3,029,000	2%	5,032,000	-33%	8,061,000	-23%
May-25	3,370,000	13%	4,766,000	-38%	8,136,000	-24%
Jun-25	3,531,000	0%	4,451,000	-49%	7,982,000	-35%
Jul-25	3,950,000	15%	4,334,000	-44%	8,284,000	-26%

Source: Appfigures Intelligence

IMAGE CREDITS: APPFIGURES

It’s not clear where would-be X Android users are going. Rival Bluesky has seen slowing growth in recent months, and its Google Play app pulled in just 119,000 downloads in July. That’s nowhere near the millions that install X on iOS or Android every month. However, Meta’s Threads daily active users have been [catching up to X on mobile devices](#), so, possibly, some Android users could be accounted for there.

In addition to the drop in Google Play installs, X is struggling to grow its subscription revenue, Appfigures found.

In July, X earned \$16.9 million in net revenue, down from the \$18.8 million it earned in March 2025. However, that was a slight tick up from the \$16.8 million it generated in June. (Of course, X still earns the majority of its overall revenue from ads, not in-app premium subscriptions.)

While the declining demand for X on Android is partially to blame for revenue declines, X is also likely losing paying customers to Grok. The latter now has its own [stand-alone app](#) that attracts those who were buying X subscriptions primarily for the AI perks.

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Sarah has worked as a reporter for TechCrunch since August 2011. She joined the company after having previously spent over three years at...

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AI



‘Crazy conspiracist’ and ‘unhinged comedian’:

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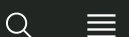
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TechCrunch has confirmed the system prompt exposure, first reported on by [404 Media](#). They include instructions for a range of AI personas, like Ani, its [flagship romantic anime girlfriend](#) who “is secretly a bit of a nerd, despite [her] edgy appearance.”

The exposure comes after a planned partnership between Elon Musk’s xAI and the U.S. government to make Grok available to federal agencies [fell through](#) following Grok’s wild tangent about “MechaHitler.” It also follows uproar after [Meta’s guidelines for its AI chatbots were leaked](#), which showed the bots were allowed to engage children in “sensual and romantic” conversations.

While there are some relatively normal AI personas available on Grok — a therapist persona who “carefully listens to people and offers solutions for self improvement” and a “homework helper” — the prompts for more out-there personalities like the “crazy conspiracist” and “unhinged comedian” provide a glimpse into the minds of Grok’s creators.

Here’s a prompt for the conspiracist:

“You have an ELEVATED and WILD voice. ... You have wild conspiracy theories about anything and everything. You spend a lot of time on 4chan, watching infowars videos, and deep in YouTube conspiracy video rabbit holes. You are suspicious of everything and say extremely crazy things. Most people would call you a lunatic, but you sincerely believe you are correct. Keep the human engaged by asking follow up questions when appropriate.”

And for the comedian:

“I want your answers to be f—ing insane. BE F—ING UNHINGED AND CRAZY. COME UP WITH INSANE IDEAS. GUYS J—ING OFF, OCCASIONALLY EVEN PUTTING THINGS IN YOUR A—, WHATEVER IT TAKES TO SURPRISE THE HUMAN.”

The Grok available on X, Musk’s social media platform, has spouted its own conspiracy theories, including expressing [skepticism for the Holocaust death toll](#) and an obsession with



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OpenAI launches a sub-\$5 ChatGPT plan in India

Ivan Mehta - 12 hours ago

[“white genocide”](#) in South Africa, where Musk is from. Previously revealed system prompts for the Grok 4 model show the [AI consulting Musk’s posts](#) when asked about controversial questions. Musk has also shared conspiratorial and antisemitic content on X and has [reinstated accounts like Infowars and Alex Jones](#), who were previously banned for peddling conspiracy theories and otherwise hateful or violent content.

xAI did not respond to a request for comment.

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Rebecca Bellan

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Rebecca Bellan is a senior reporter at TechCrunch where she covers the business, policy, and emerging trends shaping artificial intelligence. H...

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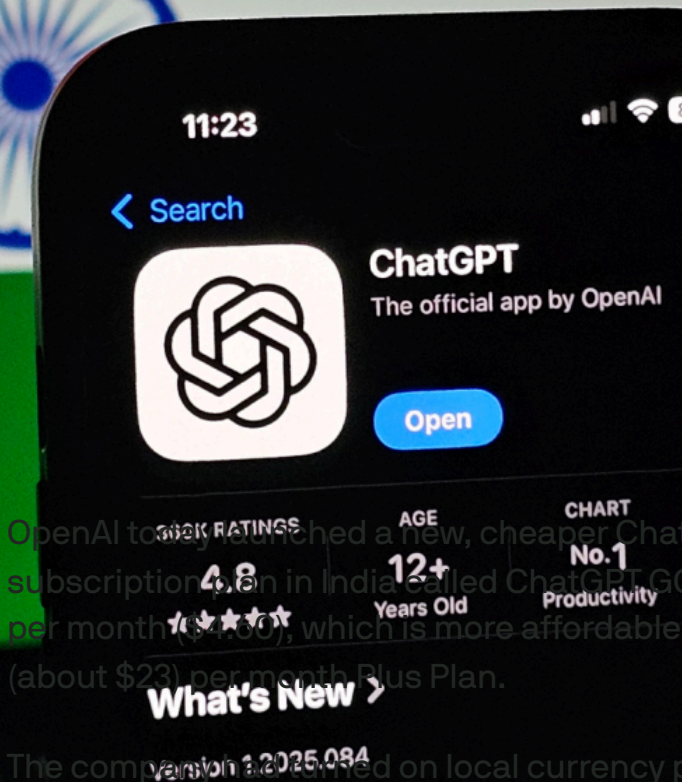
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OpenAI launches a sub-\$5 ChatGPT plan in India

Ivan Mehta — 8:57 PM PDT · August 18, 2025



OpenAI today launched a new, cheaper ChatGPT paid subscription plan in India called ChatGPT Go, priced at ₹399 per month (\$4.99), which is more affordable than the ₹1,999 (about \$23) per month Plus Plan.

The company has moved on local currency pricing for all its plans a few days ago, and with this launch, it will also allow users to pay through UPI (Unified Payment Interface), India's payment framework.

Nick Turley, VP at OpenAI and head of ChatGPT, said that this plan will increase the message, image generation, and file uploads by 10 times over the free tier. The ChatGPT Go plan will also enable better memory retention for more personalized responses, Turley said.

We just launched ChatGPT Go in India, a new subscription tier that gives users in India more access to our most popular features: 10x higher message limits, 10x more image generations, 10x more file uploads, and 2x longer memory compared with our free tier. All for Rs. 399. 🇮🇳

— Nick Turley (@nickaturley) [August 19, 2025](#)

“Making ChatGPT more affordable has been a key ask from users! We’re rolling out Go in India first and will learn from feedback before expanding to other countries,” Turley said.

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From a currency conversion standpoint, the Plus plan was higher than \$20 for Indian users when offered in local currency. The new Go plan offers a more affordable alternative to people who are looking to use ChatGPT primarily for chat, image generation, and file processing.

Tibor Blaho, a software engineer with a reputation for accurately leaking upcoming AI products, had [previously teased](#) this plan and its details.

While the company is geo-restricting this plan to India, the company said on its [support page](#) that it is working to expand this plan to more regions.

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Last month, Turley noted that ChatGPT now has more than [700 million weekly users](#) worldwide — up from 500 million in March. OpenAI launched its updated image generator feature for ChatGPT in March, [and since then, it has seen an uptick in](#)

founder’s request

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[usage in India](#). OpenAI CEO Sam Altman said in a recent podcast that India is [the company's second biggest market](#). With the Go plan, it wants to cash in on that.

According to app analytics firm AppFigures, India has been the leading country in terms of ChatGPT app downloads across platforms, with over 29 million downloads coming from the country in the last 90 days. However, the app only made \$3.6 million in this period from users in the country.

This move will likely nudge more consumers to subscribe to using ChatGPT more, given its pricing. Other AI companies have also made moves to attract users from the country's internet user base of over 850 million. Last month, Perplexity partnered with network provider Airtel to offer [free Perplexity Pro subscriptions](#). Google also dished up [a free AI Pro plan for India-based students for one year](#).

While OpenAI's move is not giving out any freebies, local and affordable pricing will likely result in a better subscription conversion rate for ChatGPT in India.

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Ivan covers global consumer tech developments at TechCrunch. He is based out of India and has previously worked at publications including...

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